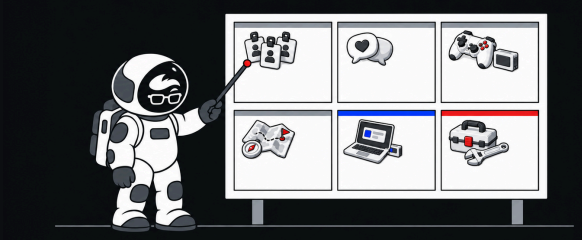
Six questions about the people around your product

The Participation Lens. Pick one product and give it 20 minutes. Write down what people already do around it, not what you hope they will do.



1 Who takes part?

- [ ] Customers
- [ ] Admins
- [ ] Developers
- [ ] Creators
- [ ] Partners
- [ ] Your own employees
- [ ] Ambassadors and superusers
- [ ] Fans and players
- [ ] Consultants and agencies

Doing the most: _____

2 Why do they do it?

- [ ] To learn
- [ ] To get help
- [ ] To be recognised
- [ ] To earn
- [ ] To build their own thing
- [ ] To shape the product
- [ ] To help others
- [ ] To connect with peers
- [ ] For the fun of it

Ask one of them. Their answer: _____

3 What do they make?

- [ ] Answers
- [ ] Posts
- [ ] Guides and videos
- [ ] Templates
- [ ] Code and integrations
- [ ] Feedback and bug reports
- [ ] Referrals
- [ ] Events

What others rely on most: _____

4 Where does it happen?

- [ ] Your platform
- [ ] Inside the product
- [ ] Discord or Slack
- [ ] Reddit
- [ ] GitHub
- [ ] LinkedIn and YouTube
- [ ] Marketplaces
- [ ] Events and conferences
- [ ] Other people's communities

A place you don't run: _____

5 Who uses it?

- [ ] Other customers
- [ ] Your product team
- [ ] Support
- [ ] Sales and customer success
- [ ] Marketing
- [ ] Partners
- [ ] AI answers and search
- [ ] A dashboard

Where it goes once it's made: _____

6 Who looks after it?

Take the thing from question 3. Who keeps it working?

When it breaks: _____
When its maker leaves: _____
When your own champion leaves: _____
When your requests clash with theirs: _____
Who pays for it: _____

Read your answers

- Questions 1 to 4 describe what people already do. You can often answer them from the outside.
- Questions 5 and 6 decide whether any of it lasts.
- Mostly posts in 3 and a dashboard in 5? That is the part AI absorbs first.
- Templates, events, integrations or answers that others build on? You already run a builder ecosystem.
- Blank lines in 6 are where to start.

Your first move

Start with what people already do, then decide what to support.

One thing we'll support: _____

Who looks after it: _____

Check again on: _____

Ran it and something doesn't fit?

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Read the article behind the six questions